

Περὶ Δένδρων καὶ Ὀρνίθων Μῦθοι (Ἀνώνυμος)

Fables of Trees and Birds from Late Antique Verse

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Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος Verse

Life

The Fables of Trees and Birds is an anonymous poetic work dated to the Late Antique period, from the 3rd to the 5th century CE. No biographical details of the author survive. The composition exists within a period of cultural transition and employs the traditional Aesopic fable form in verse, suggesting a continuation of classical didactic or rhetorical purposes.

Works

The sole known work is the Fables of Trees and Birds, a fragmentary collection of verse fables. The original extent and total number of its constituent fables are unknown.

Significance

This collection is a significant artifact of Late Antique Greek literary culture, demonstrating the enduring adaptation of the classical fable genre. Its poetic use of Koine Greek and its moralistic themes illustrate the persistence of traditional forms and didacticism. The work's fragmentary state is typical of the period and underscores the challenges of reconstructing late antique literary production.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα Π. Ἐἰδελβέργ 222 · [Fragments P. Heidelberg 222](#) · 26 passages